



Waterline



Private preview · Operating in stealth

Turn performing loans into dependable funding.

Credit infrastructure that lets Nigerian lenders
access institutional capital against their own loan
books — without giving up equity.

Company overview – for discussion purposes
Lagos, Nigeria · 2026

— THE PROBLEM

Nigerian lenders sit on good assets they can't fund cheaply — and investors want the yield but can't verify the book.

LENDER SIDE

Banks, MFBs, fintechs and leasing companies

- **Funding is short-term and expensive** — deposits and short lines don't match the tenor of the loans they've already written.
- **Institutional capital is out of reach** — raising a bond, forward-flow or securitization needs a data room most lenders can't produce on their own.
- **Every structuring conversation starts from zero** — no shared data format, no reusable diligence trail, no comparable to point to.

INVESTOR SIDE

Institutional investors and DFIs seeking Nigerian credit yield

- **No standardized loan tape to underwrite against** — every lender's export is a different shape, in a different currency of trust.
- **No independent portfolio context** — assessing one lender's book means building institution-level comparables from scratch, deal by deal.
- **Structuring is bespoke and slow** — eligibility screening, tranching and cashflow modelling get rebuilt for every pool.

The lending market has grown faster than the infrastructure that funds it.

01

A bigger, more diverse lending base

Digital lenders, MFBs and leasing/asset-finance companies have originated at scale over the last decade, alongside the traditional banks — most of it funded on-balance-sheet.

02

Off-balance-sheet funding is now the constraint

Growth is capped less by origination capability and more by the ability to move performing loans off-balance-sheet into structures institutional capital will actually buy.

03

No shared credit-data standard exists locally

Unlike more developed securitization markets, there is no common loan-data format or standardized validation layer that a Nigerian lender's tape can be checked against before it reaches an investor.

04

Deal teams still work like it's diligence-by-PDF

Sourcing, benchmarking and structuring still run on scraped filings, static pitch decks and one-off spreadsheet models — rebuilt fresh for every transaction.

Waterline

Waterline is **credit infrastructure** for Nigerian lenders — the data standard, market intelligence and deal-structuring layer that turns a performing loan book into a pool institutional capital can underwrite.

01

Market Intelligence

Institution and portfolio-level data — NPL ratios, ratings, capital-markets activity — sourced from public filings, so sourcing and benchmarking start from evidence, not a pitch.

SOURCING & BENCHMARKING

02

Data Standard (WCDS)

A canonical loan-data schema and deterministic validation rulebook that maps a lender's raw tape into a clean, audit-ready loan book investors can actually underwrite.

STANDARDIZATION

03

SPV Structuring

Eligibility screening, Senior/Mezzanine/Equity tranche sizing and a cashflow waterfall simulation that turns a validated pool into a structured, investable transaction.

DEAL EXECUTION

One workflow, from a raw loan tape to a closed, funded structure.

1

Discovery

Lender shares a loan tape under NDA; Waterline reviews portfolio quality against market context from Tier 1 data.

2

Structure

The tape is mapped and canonicalized against the Waterline Credit Data Standard (WCDS) into a clean, comparable loan book.

3

Validate

The book runs through a 30-rule validation and reconciliation engine; eligible facilities are screened and tranches sized.

4

Close

A cashflow waterfall is modelled across tranches and the structure is placed with investors — with investor-grade reporting throughout.

The Waterline Credit Data Standard (WCDS)

Every lender's export looks different. WCDS gives them one canonical shape — and a deterministic rulebook that catches the errors that would otherwise surface mid-deal.

- 18

Canonical entities
Facility, FacilitySnapshot, Party, Collateral, Payment, Schedule, CreditRisk and more — a full loan data model, not a flat spreadsheet.
- 30

Deterministic validation rules
Every tape is checked against the same 30-rule rulebook — no silent gaps, no "trust me" fields.
- **Map → canonicalize → validate → reconcile**
Raw CSV/XLSX in; a clean, control-totalled, audit-ready loan book out.

Validation summary	
Reconciled	
Control totals	Matched
Facility status consistency	Pass
Currency & unit consistency	Pass
DPD / arrears logic	Pass
Concentration limits	Flagged — 2
Deep entities	Skipped

SPV structuring & cashflow waterfall

Once a book is clean, Waterline turns it into a structure — the same eligibility, sizing and cashflow logic an arranger would build by hand, run consistently every time.

- 1

Eligibility screening
Status, days-past-due, default, currency, tenor and concentration limits applied against configurable deal criteria.
- 2

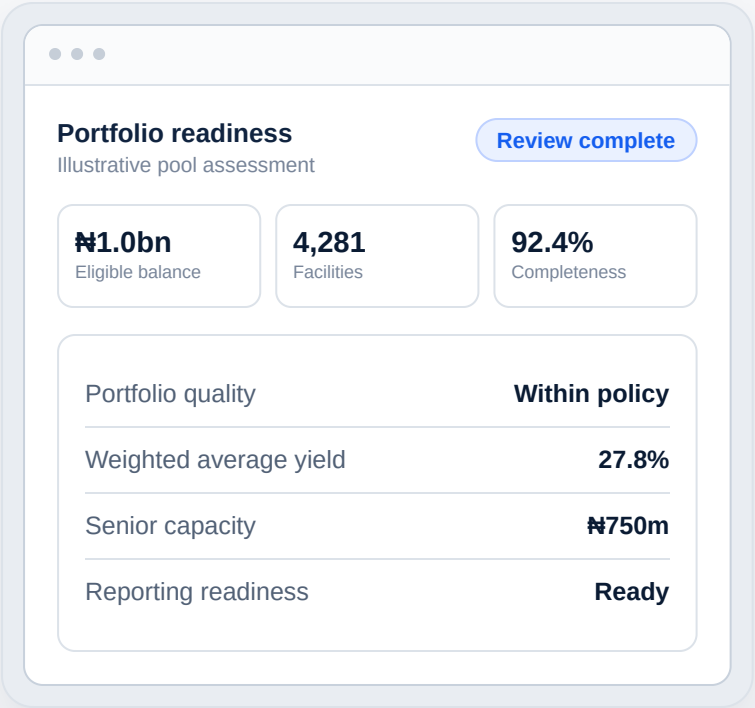
Tranche sizing
Senior, Mezzanine and Equity tranches sized off the eligible pool.
- 3

Waterfall simulation
Monthly cashflow modelling with sequential-pay allocation and stress overlays, so the structure can be pressure-tested before a term sheet.



A portfolio readiness view, backed by evidence — not a pitch.

Every figure traces back to a source document via a
provenance record, so it survives an investor's "where
did this number come from?"



Waterline is paid for infrastructure and execution — not for holding credit risk.

Waterline never takes the loans onto its own balance sheet. It is the standardization, intelligence and structuring layer that sits between a lender's book and the capital that funds it.

STANDARDIZATION

WCDS engagements

Lenders and technical partners engage Waterline directly to standardize a loan book against WCDS — an independent, fee-based service, ahead of and outside of any funding deal.

DEAL EXECUTION

Structuring & placement

Origination and structuring fees on securitization / forward-flow transactions — screening, tranching, waterfall modelling and investor placement for a validated pool.

ONGOING INFRASTRUCTURE

Data & reporting

Recurring fees for investor reporting, portfolio monitoring and market-intelligence access across the life of a structure.

Infrastructure, not another balance sheet.

01

A real data standard, not a spreadsheet template

WCDS is a full canonical schema with a deterministic rulebook — built and tested end-to-end against synthetic loan tapes before it ever touches a real one.

02

Intelligence and execution in one workflow

Market intelligence, standardization and structuring live on one platform — most incumbents offer one of the three, requiring a lender to stitch the rest together.

03

Founding team from both sides of the table

Banking, ratings and central-banking experience across Nigerian and international institutions — the team has sat inside the institutions it now serves.

04

Neutral by design

Waterline doesn't originate or hold loans, so its incentives are aligned with getting the data and the structure right — not with maximizing its own book.

The platform is built. We're in private preview with a small group of lenders and investors.



WCDS v0.1 published

Full canonical schema, field dictionary and 30-rule validation rulebook, specified and documented.



Ingestion pipeline live

Mapper, canonicalizer, validator and reconciler built and tested end-to-end against synthetic loan tapes.



SPV structuring engine live

Eligibility screening, tranche sizing and cashflow waterfall simulation, exposed via API.



Market intelligence database live

Institution and portfolio-level schema, seeded from public filings and rating actions.

Currently in stealth. Waterline is operating a private preview with a small group of Nigerian lenders, institutional investors and transaction partners while the platform is pressure-tested ahead of a public launch.

Founders who have sat on both sides of a credit transaction.

Richard Awe

CO-FOUNDER

Financial-services and technology leader with experience across banking, central banking, government, ratings and software delivery.

Access Bank

Barclays Bank

HSBC

Lloyds Banking Group

European Central Bank

HMRC

3d7 Technologies

Fitch Ratings

Abiodun Awe

CO-FOUNDER

Markets-infrastructure and issuer-services specialist with experience across central banking, investment banking, custody and ratings.

Central Bank of Nigeria

Morgan Stanley

NatWest Markets

BBC

Co-op

Equiniti

BNY

Fitch Ratings

— VISION

The standard layer for African credit markets.

Start as the **data and structuring infrastructure** for Nigerian lenders — become the layer every credit transaction on the continent gets checked against.

NOW

Nigeria, term loans & leases

Deepen coverage across banks, MFBs, fintechs and leasing companies.

NEXT

More asset classes

Extend WCDS and structuring to trade finance, invoice discounting and consumer credit.

LATER

Pan-African coverage

Take the standard and the structuring workflow to other African credit markets facing the same funding gap.



Waterline

We'd like to talk.

Waterline is in private preview and not currently running a funding process — but we're always glad to compare notes with investors and partners who work in Nigerian credit markets.

richard.awe@3d7tech.com

Request private preview access

Waterline · Lagos, Nigeria

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